



Digital Art Imaging 1

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · COURSE SYLLABUS · 2026–2027

Full Year · High School

FACILITATOR

Optima Academy Online Faculty

FLORIDA COURSE

Florida 0108370 (Digital Art & Imaging 1) · Full-year course · 1.0 credit

GRADE LEVEL

Grades 9–12 (High School)

EMAIL & OFFICE

Your facilitator's email is posted in Canvas · 239.673.2801 (OAO Front Office)

OFFICE HOURS

Posted in Canvas · weekly editing help and critique workshops

FORMAT

On-Demand (asynchronous, with a live facilitator for grading and office hours)

About this syllabus. This is the plan for the course as designed. It is a full-year high-school course; On-Demand scholars pace through the four modules (one per quarter) across their enrolled year. On-Demand and live-school sections share the same content and expectations; exact pacing, scheduled dates, and a few activities may vary from section to section and term to term. Your facilitator will confirm the specifics for your section.

COURSE OVERVIEW

Digital Art Imaging 1 teaches the scholar to see and make with intention using digital tools. The course opens with the Elements of Art and Principles of Design applied to the screen rather than the page, then moves through photography (composition, light, and perspective), digital editing, collage and photomontage, typography, digital drawing, and a short animation, before closing with a curated portfolio and artist statement. All editing is done in Pixlr E, a free browser-based tool, so no paid software is required. Each week pairs a short interactive lesson with a hands-on digital project, and every quarter builds toward one larger piece the scholar finishes, critiques, and files in a growing portfolio. AI and digital shortcuts are examined honestly, as tools that can inform the process but never replace the scholar's own eye and choices. By the end of the year the scholar can plan, execute, and speak about a body of original digital artwork.

WHAT SCHOLARS WILL LEARN TO DO

- Define digital art and imaging and distinguish raster from vector image formats.
- Apply the Elements of Art and Principles of Design deliberately to digital compositions.
- Plan, capture, and critique original digital photographs using composition, lighting, and perspective.
- Edit and correct digital images in Pixlr E, including exposure, color adjustment, and filters.
- Build original digital collage and photomontage work using layers, masking, and blend modes.
- Use typography as a visual design element and combine it with other digital art techniques.
- Render proportion, form, and value in original digital drawings and mosaics.
- Plan and produce a short digital animation and assemble a final portfolio with a reflective artist statement.

BIG PROJECTS & MILESTONES

The course builds toward a set of finished, real-world artifacts. Target dates below follow a **sample full-year pacing**; On-Demand scholars pace to their own enrolled term and Live sections follow the class schedule, keeping each milestone roughly in order.

PROJECT / MILESTONE	COURSE PLACE	SAMPLE TARGET	WHAT YOU TURN IN
"This Is Me as a Digital Artist" (opening portfolio piece)	Module 1 (Q1) · Week 1	by Aug 21	An original digital composition built in Pixlr E using color, shape, text, and a personal symbol, filed in the scholar's portfolio folder.
End-of-Semester Project (photography & editing)	Module 2 (Q2) · Week 7	by Dec 11	A capstone piece applying the semester's photography and editing skills, submitted with a short reflection.
Surrealism Collage	Module 3 (Q3) · Weeks 3–4	by Feb 5	An original digital collage built with masking and blend modes, finished through self- and peer critique.
Final Portfolio & Artist Statement (course capstone)	Module 4 (Q4) · Week 8	by May 28 (Q4 end)	A curated selection of the year's strongest digital artwork with a written artist statement, submitted in Canvas.

IMPORTANT DATES — 2026–2027

Aug 12, 2026	First day of school	Sep 7	Holiday (Labor Day)
Oct 9	Quarter 1 ends	Oct 12	Holiday (Columbus Day)
Nov 11	Holiday (Veterans' Day)	Nov 23–27	Thanksgiving break
Dec 18	Quarter 2 ends · fall semester ends	Dec 21–Jan 1	Winter break
Jan 5, 2027	Classes resume	Jan 18	Holiday (MLK Day)
Feb 15	Holiday (Presidents' Day)	Mar 5	Quarter 3 ends
Mar 26–Apr 5	Spring break	Apr 6	Classes resume
May 28, 2027	Quarter 4 ends · last day of school	May 31	Holiday (Memorial Day)

ASSESSMENT & GRADING

60%

Projects & Portfolio (the week's teacher-graded digital artwork)

30%

Classwork, Practice & Reflections (weekly assignments and discussions)

10%

Quizzes & Critiques

HOW THIS COURSE IS DELIVERED

This course is offered in two formats that share the same content, assignments, and expectations: an **On-Demand (asynchronous)** section you pace yourself, and a **Live (synchronous)** section that meets on a schedule on Optima's VR campus. The two overviews below explain how each one works. Find the one that matches your enrollment.

ON-DEMAND (ASYNCHRONOUS) LEARNING

In the **On-Demand** section you move through the course at your own pace within each quarter, guided by due dates that keep you on track. All assignments for a quarter open at its start and close at its end. Because the course is On-Demand, there is no grade penalty for missing an individual due date — but any assignment not completed by the end of the quarter receives a **zero**, and assignments submitted in the final **14 days** of a quarter receive a **10% deduction**, so steady pacing matters.

Attendance is measured by assignment completion. Per school policy, a scholar who completes no assignment for ten consecutive school days, without notifying the school of an absence in advance, may be dropped from the course. Completion means a **sincere attempt** — real effort on real work. Rushed work, wrong or corrupted files, irrelevant or nonsense submissions, AI-generated filler, and word-salad responses do not count.



You are never on your own. A live facilitator grades your work, gives feedback, and hosts a weekly study hall and VR workshops.

LIVE (SYNCHRONOUS) LEARNING

In the **Live** section you join scheduled class meetings on Optima's VR campus, where your teacher leads instruction in real time and you learn alongside classmates. The readings, assignments, and projects are the same as the On-Demand course; what differs is the pacing — a Live section moves through the material together on the class schedule rather than at each scholar's own pace, and class time is also used for discussion, questions, and guided practice.

Attendance is measured by presence and participation. You are expected to attend the scheduled live sessions, on time and ready to take part. If you must miss a class, notify the school in advance; your teacher will let you know how to make up the work and any material you missed. As in every Optima course, completing your work means a **sincere attempt** — real effort on real work — and assignments still open and close with each quarter.



You meet regularly with a teacher. The class gathers throughout the week in VR and on Microsoft Teams for live instruction and discussion.

APPROPRIATE USE OF AI

Optima scholars are preparing for a world shaped by artificial intelligence, and learning to use these tools with good judgment is part of that preparation. You are welcome to use AI tools to **support** your learning — to explain a concept a different way, check your understanding, or brainstorm — unless a particular assignment says otherwise. What AI may **never** do is the thinking or the work an assignment asks of you: a reflection, a self-assessment, a resume, an essay, or a discussion post must be genuinely your own. Submitting AI-generated text as if it were your own work is dishonest and, as noted above, counts as an insincere attempt. When you do use an AI tool on an assignment, say so briefly. Above all, build the underlying skill yourself — the goal is for you to be able to judge whether an AI's answer is any good, which you can only do if you can do the work without it.

LEARNING IN VIRTUAL REALITY

Optima is a virtual-reality school. Alongside your Canvas coursework, you will join immersive sessions on Optima's VR campus, where you meet teachers and fellow scholars, take part in live activities, and explore places and ideas you could not visit in an ordinary classroom. Keep your headset charged and ready for any scheduled VR sessions, and treat the VR campus with the same courtesy and seriousness you would a physical one. If you ever cannot get into VR for a session, tell your facilitator — there is an alternative way to take part so you do not fall behind.

BEING AN OPTIMA SCHOLAR

Optima's mission is an excellent, virtue-centered education, and virtue is at the center of this course as much as any other. Every scholar is expected to practice the seven virtues that shape life at Optima — **courage, courtesy, honesty, perseverance, self-government, service, and responsibility**. In practice that means: do your own honest work; treat everyone you meet in, through, or because of this course with respect, in writing, in discussion, and in VR; engage actively rather than passively; come to office hours to get help, meet other scholars, and get to know your facilitator; and take responsibility for your own pacing and progress. You belong to a house and a community of scholars, not only to a course.

WHAT YOU NEED & STAYING CONNECTED

- ✓ A computer with reliable internet, a web browser, and access to **Canvas**.
- ✓ Free access to **Pixlr E** (pixlr.com/e), a browser-based editor; no paid software is required.
- ✓ A phone or camera to take original digital photographs for the photography weeks.
- ✓ **Microsoft OneDrive**, for the `DigitalArt_Portfolio_LastName` folder where all artwork is filed all year.
- ✓ Optional: a drawing tablet with layers support, for scholars who prefer to draw digitally rather than with a mouse or trackpad.
- ✓ Optional: a VR headset for the course's occasional immersive activities on Optima's VR campus (not required every week).

Staying connected. Updates about this course are posted on the course's **Canvas** page; school-wide updates are posted in your **Homeroom Canvas** course. Check both regularly. Your facilitator holds office hours and is glad to help with the material, to meet you, or to talk through your plans — come by, or reach out any time by email.